

Philosophy

#6:Reality

SYED NOMAN ALI

LECTURER

MASTER IN PHILOSOPHY, UOK

Class Learning Objectives

- Contrast between Idealism & Materialism as two metaphysical rival views.
- Understanding of Plato's Idealism by interpreting his allegory of cave.
- Differentiate Plato's objective idealism from cave theory.
- Explain Materialism and draw its criticism.

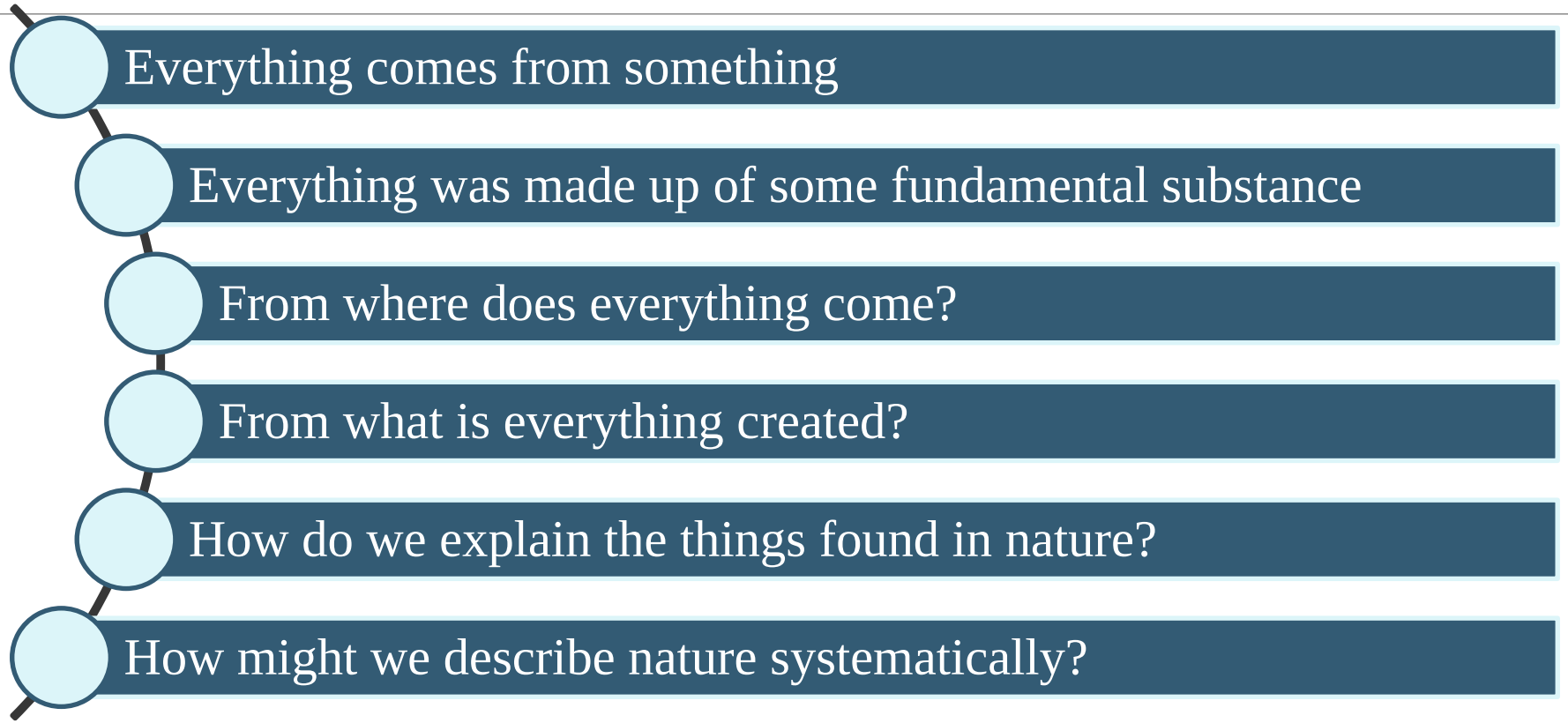
Metaphysics

Study of being

It’s the branch that deals with the “first principles” of existence, seeking to define basic concepts like existence, being, causality, substance, time, and space.

The study of “being as such” (i.e., the nature of being, or what it is for a thing to be or to exist) and the study of “the first causes of things” (i.e., their original or primary causes)

Metaphysical Questions



Types

Monism, Dualism & Pluralism

Monism
The view that there is ultimately only one substance, that all reality is one.
For e.g. : Mind or Matter

Dualism
The view that there is two fundamental substance exist.
For e.g. Mind and Body

Pluralism
The belief that the world is made of a plurality of basic elements.
For e.g Four basic element: air, fire,water& earth

Materialism

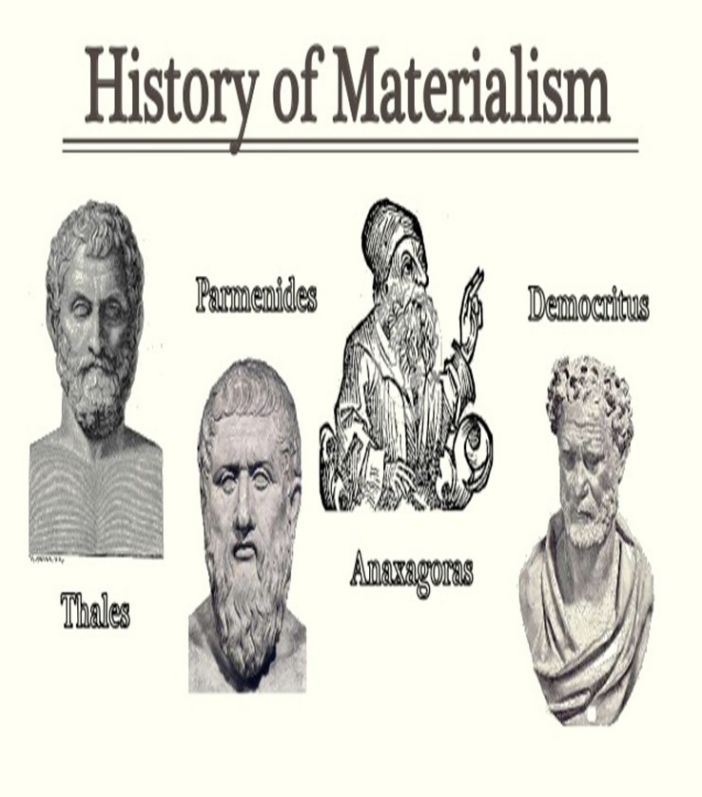
- Holds that the only thing that can be truly proven to exist is matter.
- Everything is composed of material and all phenomena are the result of material interactions.
- *Matter* is the ONLY substance.

I. REALITY AS MATTER

a. Natural Greek philosopher
b. Aristotle realism

a. Natural Greek philosophy

- Thales “All is water”
- Anaximander “All is boundless”
- Anaximenes “All is air”
- Heraclitus “All is Fire or flux “change”
- Empedocles “All are air ,water, fire and earth.
- Pythagoras “All are numbers.”
- Anaxogoras “All is indefinite seeds-mind”
- Democritus “All is matter(atoms)”



Aristotle ‘s Metaphysics

The Four Causes

Material Cause: The second matter of a present substance.

e.g marble

Formal Cause: The form of matter has taken in a present substance.

e.g Statue

Efficient Cause: Whatever generated a present substance.

e.g sculptor

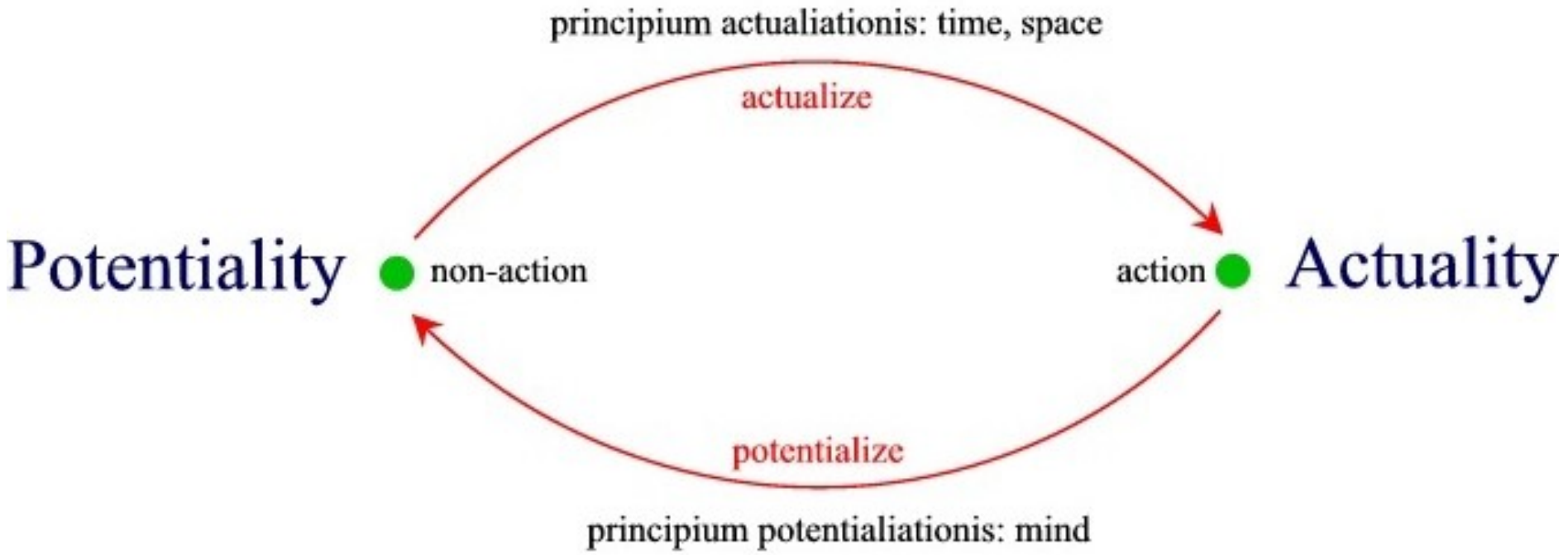
Final Cause: The purpose for which a substance was generated.

e.g honor Socrates

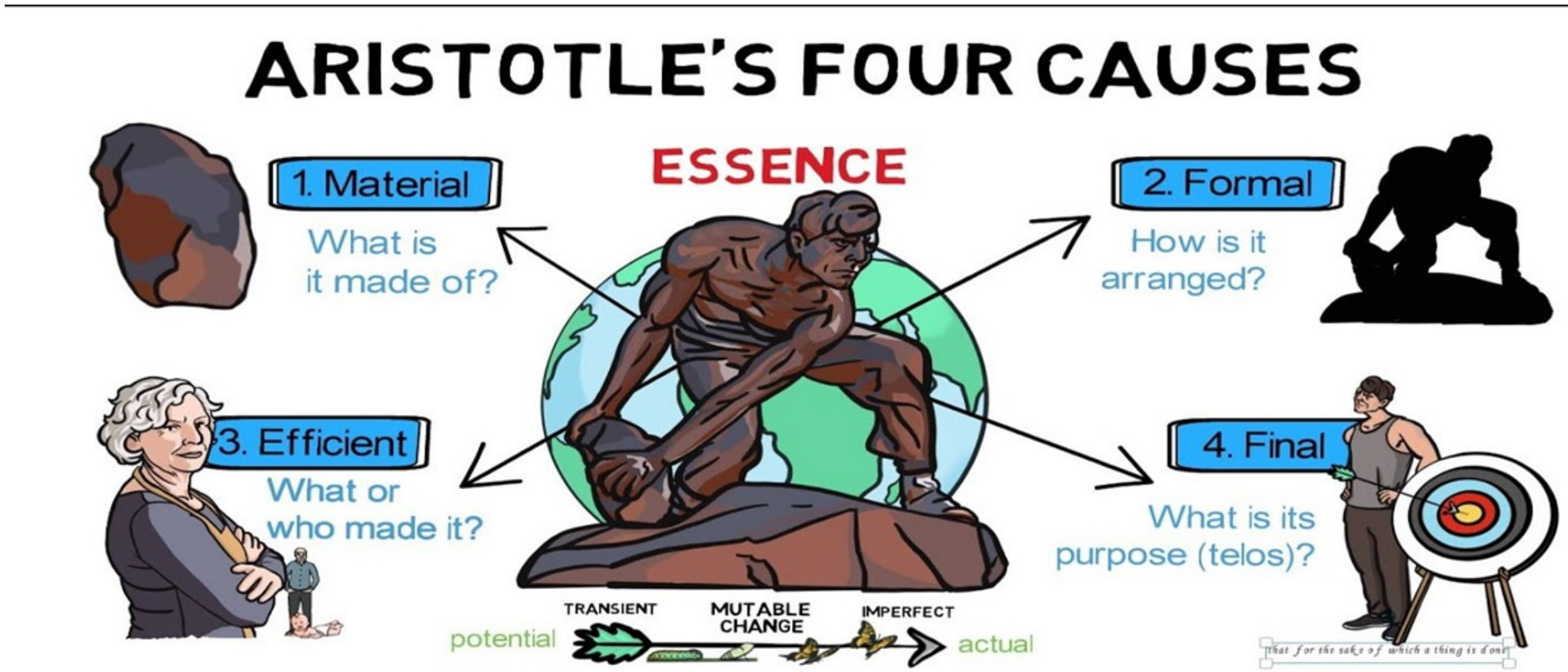
Metaphysics-Teleological

Everything has potentiality of achieving a actual form. All nature is teleological (purposive)

The ability to deliberate, to use reason in a practical and theoretical manner is the essence (function) of a human being



Theory of form : Four Causes



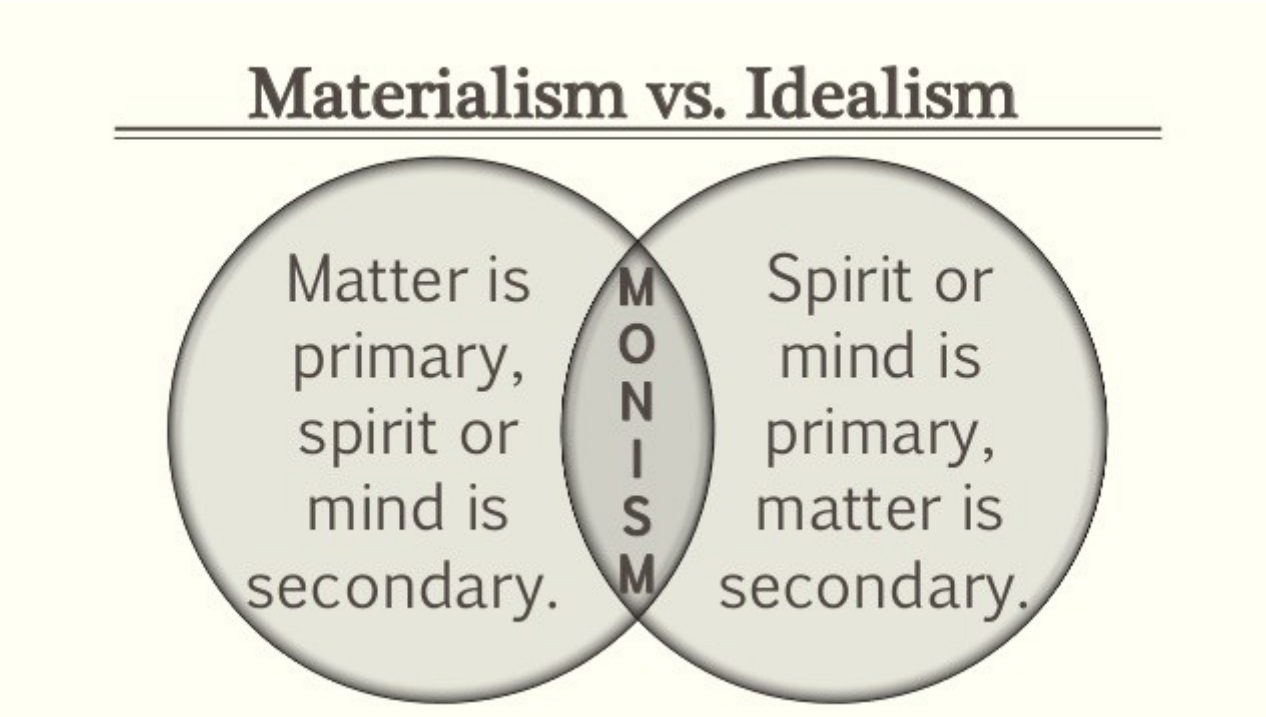
Argument for Materialism

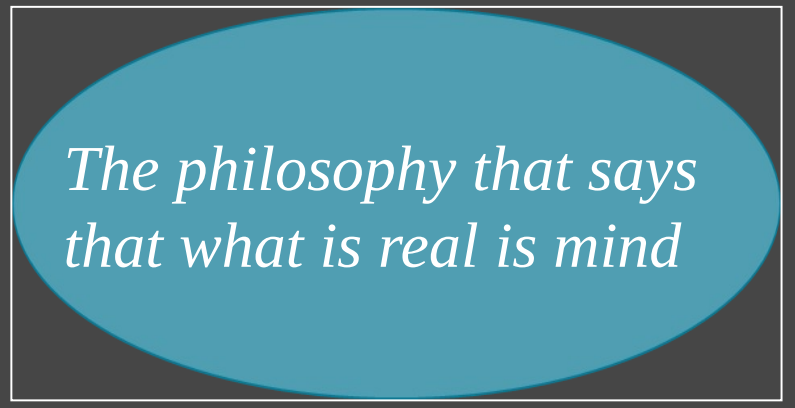
- It is a general view that everything that exists is material, or physical.
- Many philosophers use the terms `material' and `physical' interchangeably.
- It is a *metaphysical*, view that matter is the fundamental reality work with law of motion.
- Matter is inner organized energy work with law mechanics or motion.
- Mental process is also based on mechanical neuron changes.
- Mind is based on physical mental energy which comes from physical body.

Argument for Materialism

- It is a philosophy of science, which holds that the whole world is material.
- All phenomena in the universe consist of "matter in motion" according to natural laws.
- Matter precedes a thought and the thought is a reflection of material world.
- Dialectics materialism is a way of conceptualizing change in everything in nature, in history & in thought because of change in matter.
- History of world is process of struggle, contradiction & tension between opposite transforming forces which is transformed from one matter into something new form.

Differences

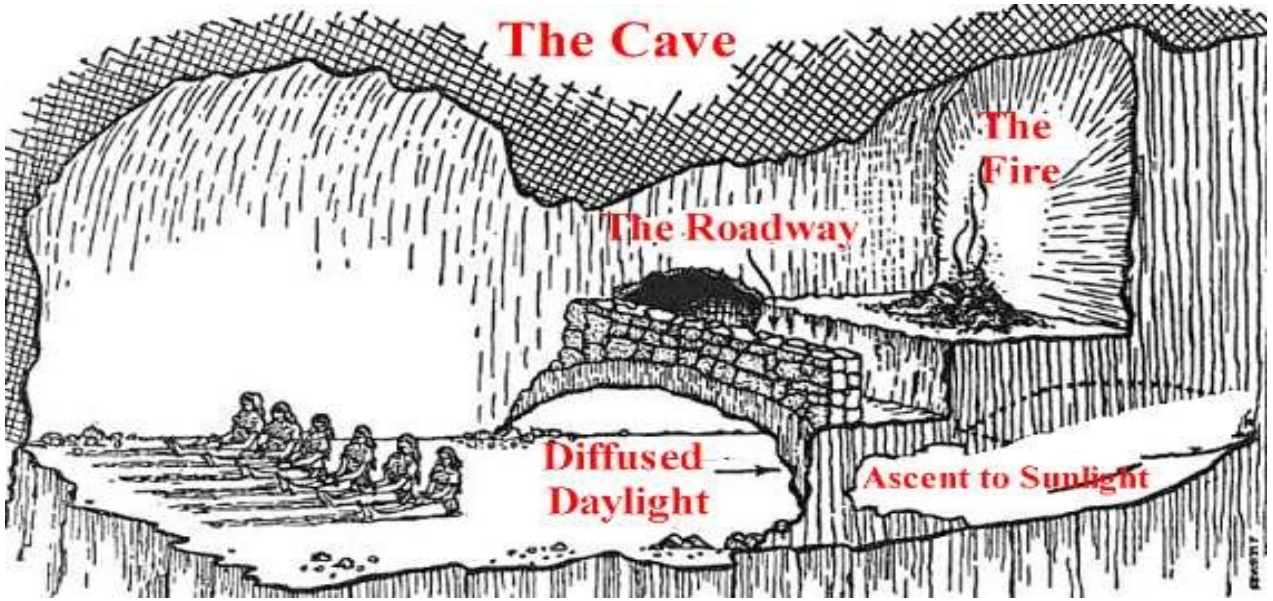




REALITY AS IDEALISM

a) Platonic idealism (Plato)
b) Subjective idealism (Berkley)

The Allegory of the Cave



- Plato explains the theory of knowledge, prisoners in cave know through the shadow on wall and fire is a source of knowledge.
- They know nothing about the world outside cave . Therefore, they suppose the reality inside.

Everything is shadow of its ideal form in the world of ideas”-Plato

- Knowledge of the world is limited to mere shadow of reality.
- Perfect from of everything exists in the world of ideas only.
- We reach to the highest from i-e absolute idea with our ability of reason.
- What we call learning is only a process of collection.

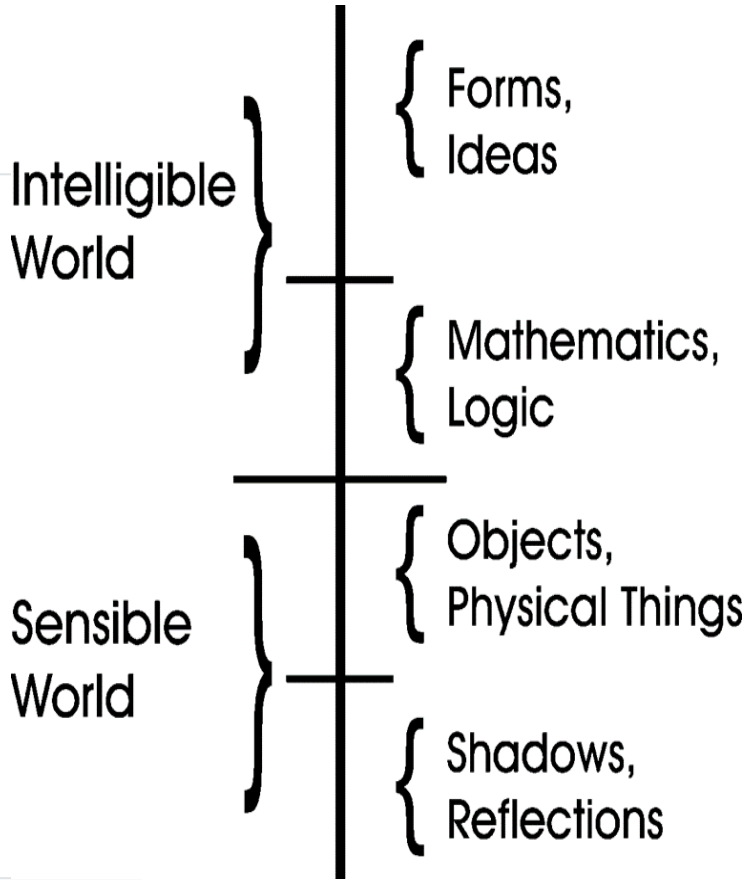
The Cave and the Line

Line

A-Imagination
B-Belief
C-Thought
D-Reason

Cave

- The shadows
- The objects on the wall
- Reflections and shadows
- Objects outside the cave



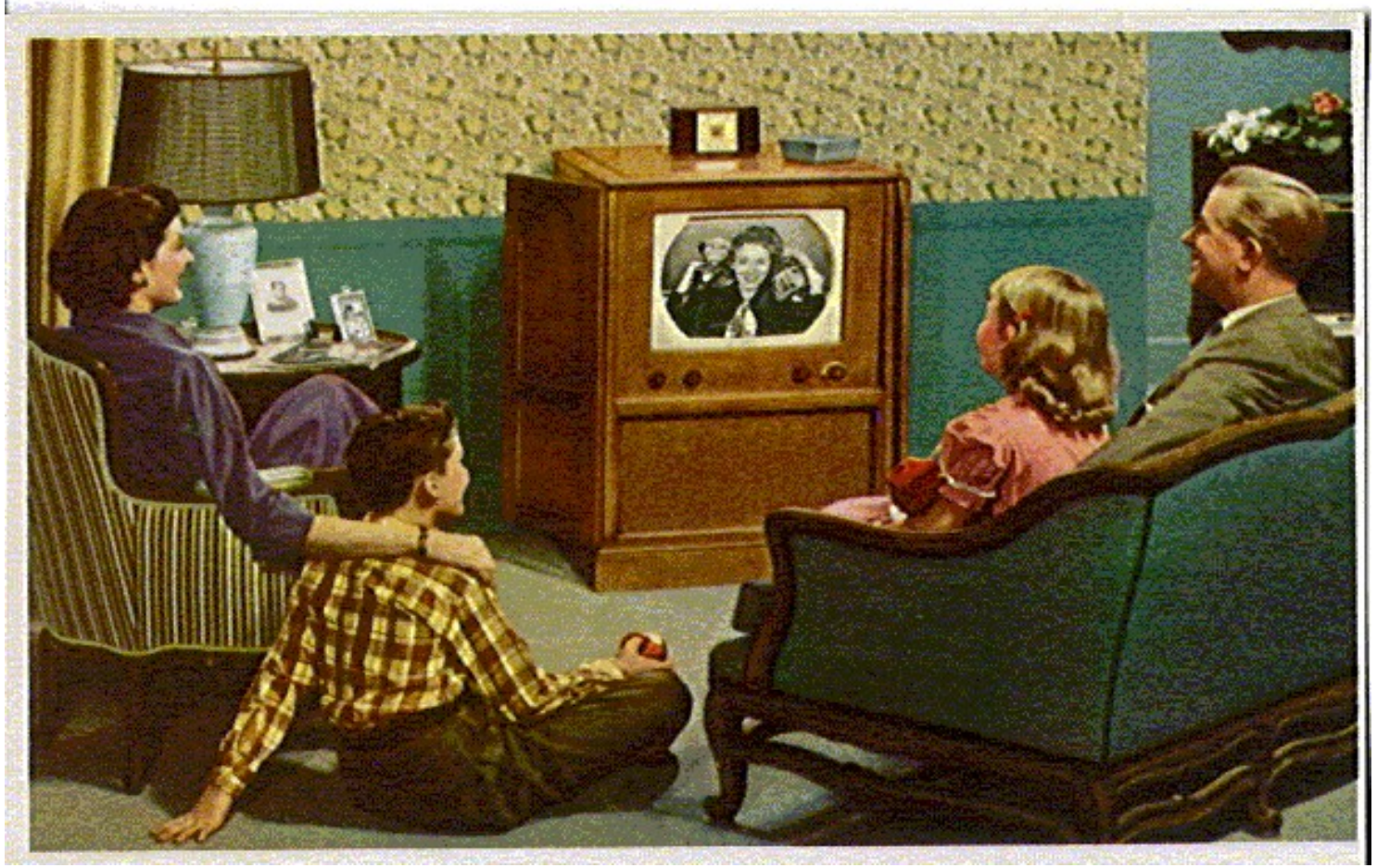
The allegory of the cave tells us…

1. that the world of our direct experience **is a shadow or imitation of the real world** equally important:

2. that the world of our direct experience **provides us with some knowledge of the divine and ultimate reality** – glimpses of perfection

3.In allegory of the cave ,we learn that all are prisoner from the birth.

…Plato's Cave…



Reality is an absolute or perfect idea.

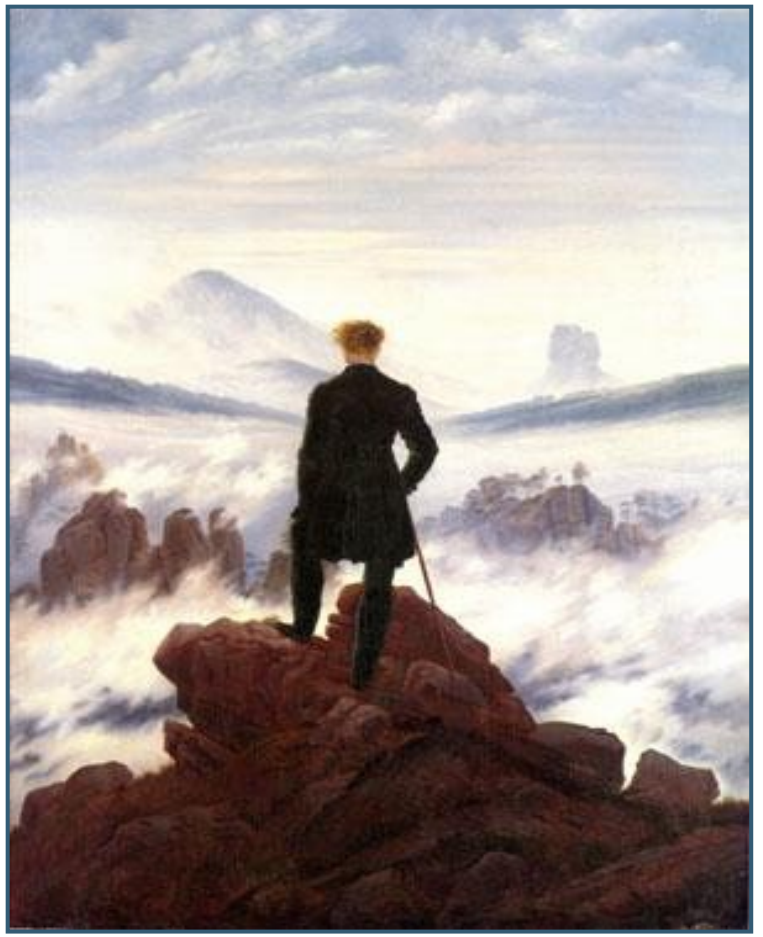
- Human ideas are shaped by the society even material also.
- Our own consciousness is representation of world.
- Absolute ideas are essential plan of all actions develop through perfectness.
- God is absolute sprit or ideas which was the master mind of all.
- All human thought is always progressive toward the absolute ideas.
- Absolute spirit comes when thought equal to object of thought.

There are only two places for things to exist…

- In our minds : Subjective Idealism (Berkley)

Or

- Outside our minds : Objective Idealism (Plato)



Argument for Objective Idealism-Plato

- We have reason to believe that something exists only in world of ideas.
- We can know an object only by making reason from mind.
- Any object of consciousness is impression in our mind as before.
- Anything exist in physical world lies in the world of ideas.
- *So, we have reason to believe that a thing exists outside mind.*

Berkley –Subjective idealism

- He thought that we can only acquire knowledge from our perceptions in mind.
- We perceive objects, what we are doing when we perceive is forming ideas about objects.
- According to him, to be or exist, is to be perceived. The world is composed of two things, ideas and minds.
- To be a idea it must be perceived by a mind which is a perceiving thing.
- To continues to exist because it continues to be perceived.
- God is an infinite mind that perceives all things. To continue exist is to be an idea in the mind of God.

Modern Idealist

Some other Idealist thinkers are Kant, Schopenhauer & Hegel.

- Kant said “ if I remove thinking, the world is vanish.”
- Schopenhauer said “Man takes the limits of his own vision for the limit of the world.”
- Hegel said “Reality is a historical progress”

Differences

MATERIALISM

All reality is matter only.

Matter is based on law of motion.

The real world is material world only.

Matter precede the thought.

Dialectic materialism said that history is the result of change in matter.

IDEALISM

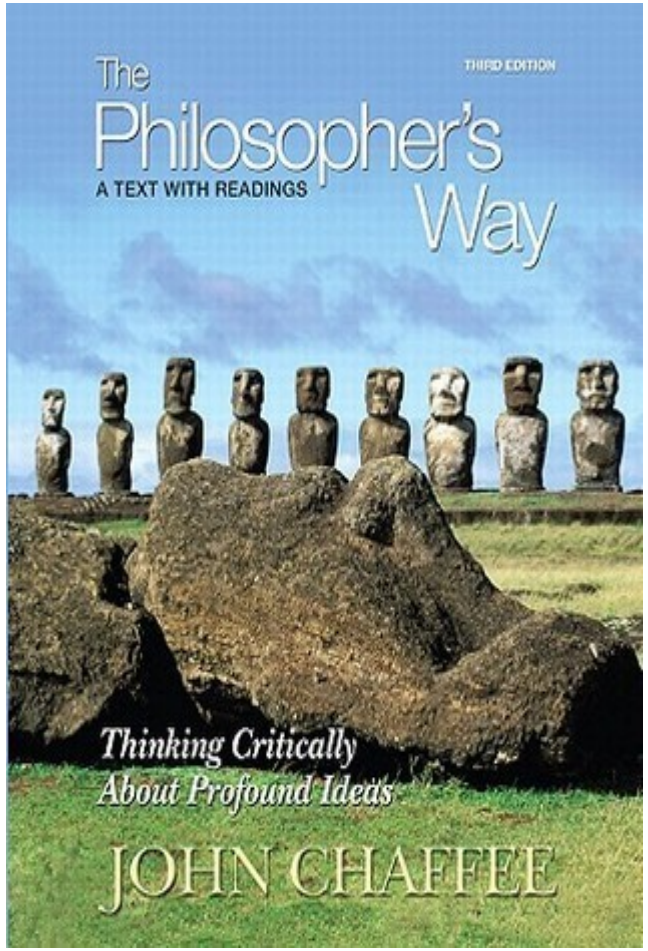
Reality is an absolute ideas.

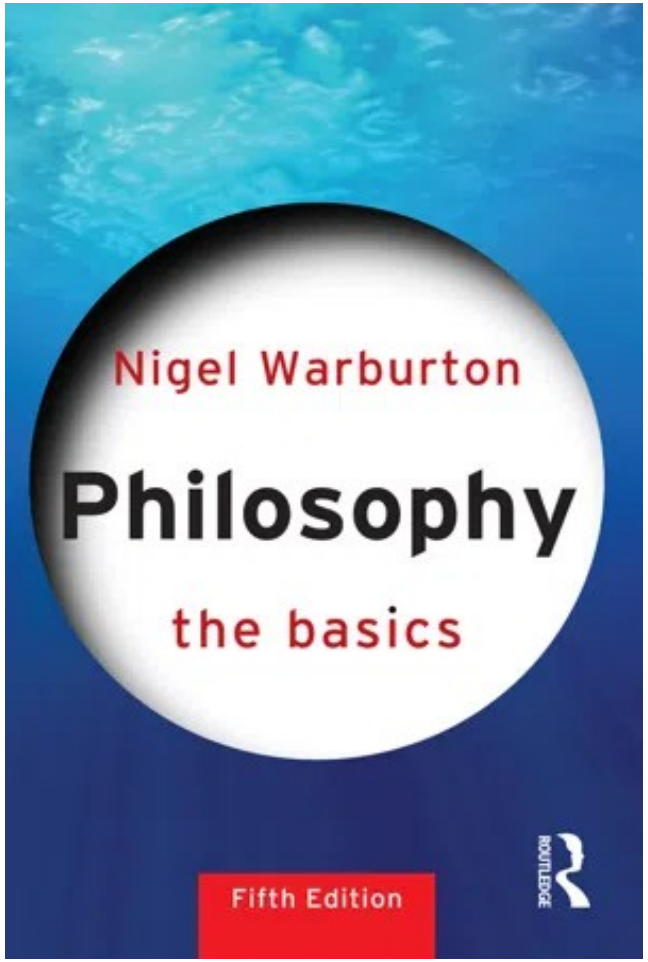
Ideas is based on reason from mind.

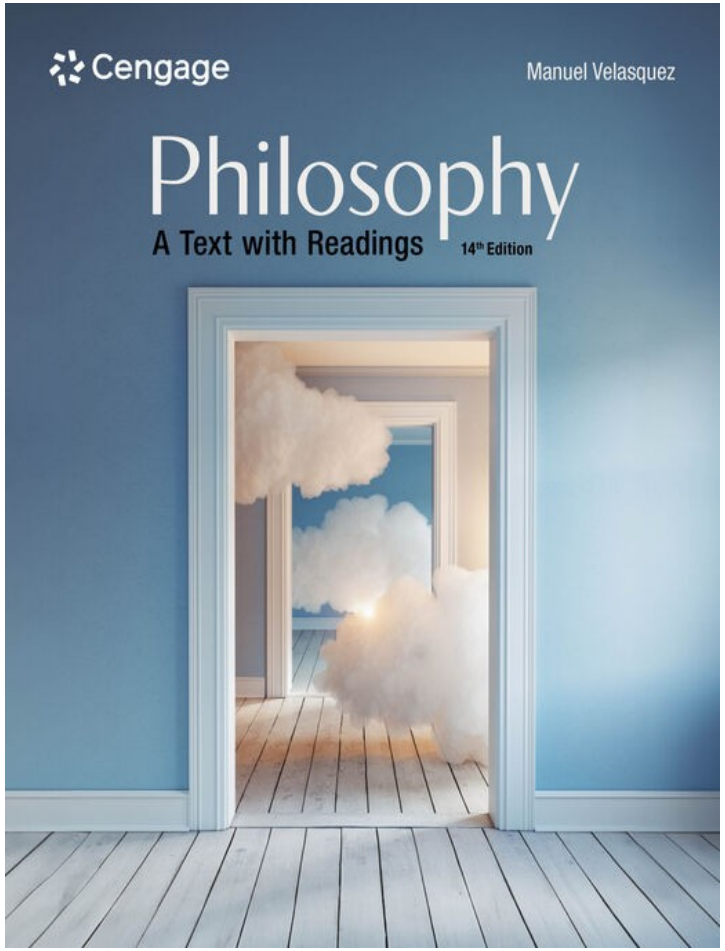
The real world is ideal world only.

Thought must create the things.

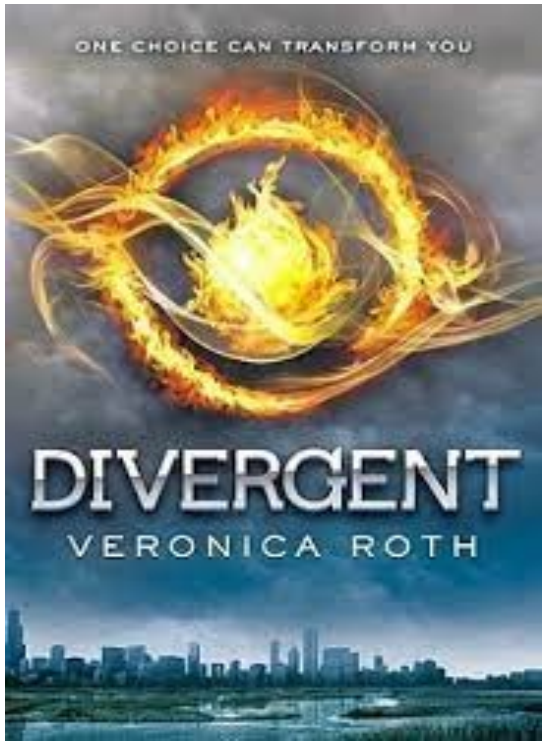
Human societies are also shaped by change in ideas.

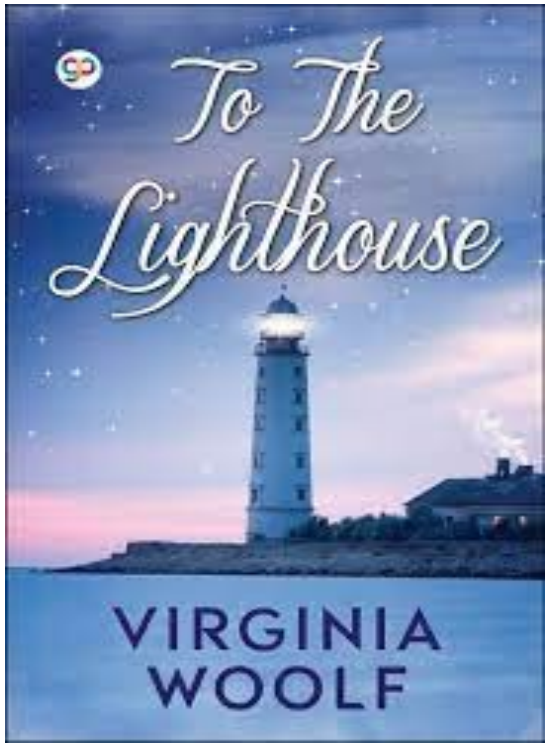

THIRD EDITION
The Philosopher's Way
A TEXT WITH READINGS
Thinking Critically About Profound Ideas
JOHN CHAFFEE

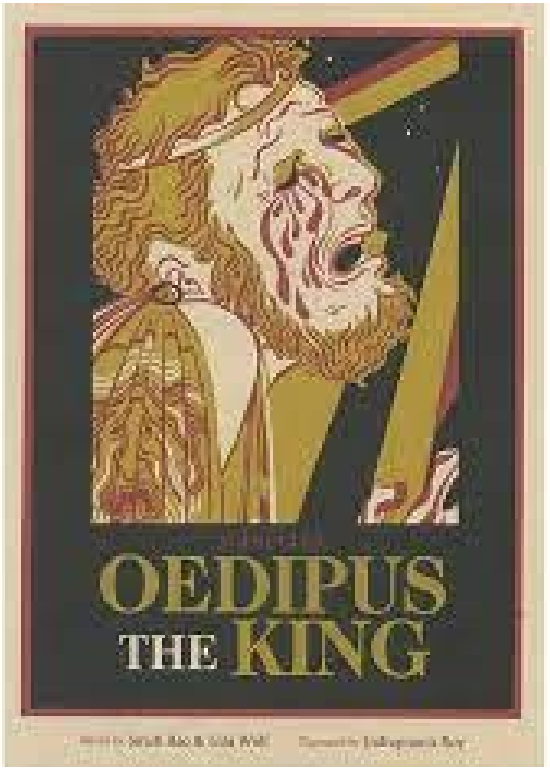

Nigel Warburton
Philosophy
the basics
Fifth Edition
ROUTLEDGE


Cengage
Manuel Velasquez
Philosophy
A Text with Readings
14th Edition

Literature review on Reality





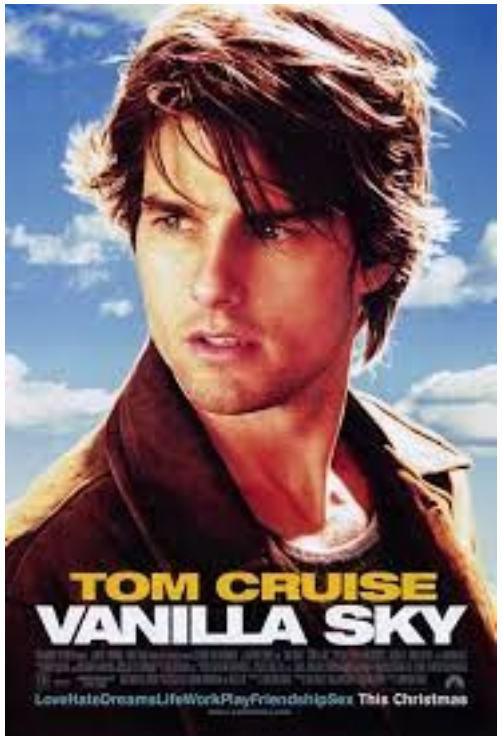


Movie review on Reality











http://www.youtube.com/@Snathought

Thank You !